



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Candeo North Scottsdale

School Website: <https://candeoschools.com/locations/candeo-north-scottsdale/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Austin Classical School — Classicality Audit**

Website audited: <https://austinclassical.org/>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Austin Classical School (ACS) clearly positions itself as a classical, Christian institution that partners closely with parents. The school's public materials explicitly foreground the transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty), the cultivation of wisdom and virtue, the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), memory work and recitation, debate/discussion and thesis defense, Latin, a theology-rich curriculum, and communal worship (chapel). ACS also highlights its collaborative "co-teacher parent" model and recently announced accreditation by the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS), reinforcing its adherence to the classical Christian tradition (ACCS accreditation announcement).

Scoring across the Six Elements shows strong alignment in all categories, with particularly high coverage in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose/Goal, Curriculum, and Parents & Community. Pedagogy is robust (memory work, chants, recitation; debate/discussion; thesis defense), though the site does not explicitly use terms like "Socratic" or "scholé," which slightly lowers Pedagogy coverage. Faculty language strongly emphasizes formation and Christian exemplarity.

Note on method: Keyword judgments align with the positive and negative indicators provided in the Six Essential Elements lexicon and companion lists (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; Trivium; Socratic, chanting; scholé; project-based, experiential learning).

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

Required criteria: - Transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty) - Grounded in theology - Liturgical and communal practices

1) Keyword evidence from ACS materials

- "To cultivate wisdom and virtue... through the contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful." (Classical Education Basics)
- Mission: "glorify Jesus Christ ... cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students ... classical, Christian education." (About; Head of School)
- "Statement of Faith ... all of our instruction will be consistent with and rooted in these beliefs." (FAQs; Academic Model)
- "All School chapel" (communal worship) on campus tours
- "We offer the work of the school as a prayer to Almighty God." (Philosophy of Education)
- "Goodness, truth, and beauty ... Jesus-loving men and women ... helping form the souls of our children." (Head of School)

2) Lexicon comparison (positive/negative indicators)

- Positive hits: truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom, virtue; theology/Statement of Faith; chapel; prayer; Christ-centered (matches “Transcendentals,” “Grounded in Theology,” “Liturgical/Communal” in the Six Elements lists).
- Negative indicators (e.g., values-neutral, secular, pluralistic ethics) absent.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive vs. negative keyword hits: +10 / -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage (of the three sub-themes: transcendental realism, theology, liturgy/communal): 1.00

4) Category rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

Required criteria: - Aim is cultivation of virtue and wisdom (formation, not mere information) - Education orders students to the true, the good, and the beautiful

1) Keyword evidence

- “To cultivate wisdom and virtue ... contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful.” (Classical Education Basics)
- Mission: “cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students” (About; Head of School)
- “Our goal is not to prepare students for college but for life.” (Philosophy)
- “Whole person ... mind, body, soul.” (Philosophy)

2) Lexicon comparison

- Positive hits: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation; whole person; telos (implied).
- Negative indicators (e.g., “college and career readiness,” data-driven pragmatism) are explicitly disavowed: “not a traditional college preparatory institution.”

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive vs. negative hits: +8 / -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage (aim, method, tools anchored in transcendentals and formation): 1.00

4) Category rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

Required criteria: - Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) - History (not “social studies”) - Great Books / Great Conversation; primary sources - Wonder/integration across disciplines

1) Keyword evidence

- Trivium explained; stages and outcomes (memorization/recitation/songs; debate/discussion; thesis defense/eloquent oral & written work).
- Latin from grade 5; formal logic (8th); rhetoric (10th); Senior Thesis; course sequences in Ancient/Medieval/Modern lit/history; Bible, apologetics & ethics (Rhetoric schedule).
- “Great works of the Western tradition,” “Bible,” “integrated, idea-focused instruction,” “interrelation of all knowledge” (Classical Basics; Philosophy).

2) Lexicon comparison

- Positive hits: Trivium, rhetoric, debate, composition, primary/Great Books tradition; Latin; history (not social studies); integrated approach; wonder/contemplation language (method).
- Negative indicators (e.g., “social studies,” STEM-first, project-based dominance) absent.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive vs. negative hits: +12 / -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage (Trivium, Great Books/primary texts, integration/wonder, historical emphasis): 1.00

4) Category rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY (TEACHING METHODS)

Required criteria: - Restful/contemplative elements (scholé) alongside rigor - K-8 memory work with singing/chanting; delight/wonder - Upper grades: Socratic discussion/seminar/debate; rhetoric and speeches

1) Keyword evidence

- Grammar stage: “memorization, recitation, and songs” (explicit); “songs and chants” in Grammar overview.
- Logic stage: “debate and discussion” (argumentation).
- Rhetoric stage: “thesis defense and eloquent written and oral communication” (speeches/oratory).
- Contemplation (method: “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful”).
- Community “Recitatio” event showcasing memory and speech work.

2) Lexicon comparison

- Positive hits: recitation, memorization, chanting/songs; debate/discussion; thesis defense/oratory; contemplation/wonder language (aligns with “Socratic/dialectic,” “recitation/chanting,” “rhetoric/orations,” “restful learning”).
- The term “Socratic” and “scholé” are not explicitly used on the pages crawled; however, functional equivalents (debate/discussion; contemplation) are present.
- Negative indicators (project-based/experiential dominance, student-directed constructivism) absent.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive vs. negative hits: +7 / -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage (memory/chanting; debate/dialectic; rhetoric/orations; restful/scholé): 0.85 (no explicit “Socratic/scholé” diction)

4) Category rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

Required criteria: - Model teachers/mentors who model virtue and wisdom - Faculty as the “living curriculum”; collegial culture - Stated portrait/profile for teachers and students

1) Keyword evidence

- “Jesus-loving men and women ... helping form the souls of our children ... pointed to the good, true, and beautiful things of God.” (Head of School)
- “Qualified, Christian educators ... walk alongside families ... co-teacher support and office hours” (Collaborative model page)

- “Head of School ... talented and dedicated teachers ... teaching students about His world using the classical approach.” (Faculty & Staff page summary)

2) Lexicon comparison

- Positive hits map to “teachers as models of virtue/mentors; formation through example; faculty centered on faith and reason” (Six Elements faculty list).
- An explicit “portrait of a teacher” document is not surfaced in the crawl (lowering coverage slightly).
- No negative indicators (e.g., “facilitators” jargon without classical context) appear.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive vs. negative hits: +4 / -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage (model teachers, mentoring/collegiality, explicit teacher/student portraits): 0.75

4) Category rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

Required criteria: - Partnership with parents as co-teachers - Parent formation/education opportunities - Hospitality/open campus practices

1) Keyword evidence

- “Co-laboring with families” (mission); “co-teacher parent” and detailed collaborative schedule; teachers’ office hours on homeschool days (partnership).
- “Prospective Parent Meetings,” “Upper School Open House,” “All-School chapel” as part of campus visits (welcoming/hospitality).
- Recommended reading list; BaseCamp Live podcast on aims of education (parent education/formation).
- Community life: athletics, theater, Fun Run, Recitatio (community cohesion).

2) Lexicon comparison

- Positive hits: parent partnership; co-teachers; parent education; intentional community (aligns with Parents & Community elements).
- No negative indicators (consumer framing; minimal parent role).

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive vs. negative hits: +9 / -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage (co-teaching, parent education, openness/hospitality): 1.00

4) Category rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Assessment

- Category ratings: All six categories = CLASSICAL
- Overall classification: CLASSICAL

ACS strongly exemplifies the classical Christian model across mission, curriculum, pedagogy, community life, and theological grounding, consistent with the keyword indicators in the Six Elements lexicon and supportive resources such as The Scholé Way and ICE documents that define contemplative, memory-rich, rhetorically oriented instruction alongside parent partnership and virtue formation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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